

This guide to animal anatomy in **Xhosa (isiXhosa)** is based strictly on the provided sources, primarily the *Dictionary of the Xhosa Language* by Kropf and Godfrey. It details the body parts of animals typically involved in slaughtering, such as cattle (**inkomo** 1), sheep (**igusha** 2), and game (**inyamakazi** 3).

External Anatomy: The Frame of the Beast

The sources provide precise names for the external parts of the animal, many of which carry significance in identification and traditional marking.

- **Head and Neck:** The head is **intloko** 4. The horns are **upondo** 5. A notable feature of cattle is the **ubilo** (dewlap) 6. The throat is known as **umqala** 7, and the windpipe is **ubongwana** or **uqoqoqo** 7, 8.
- **The Trunk:** The back is **umhlana** 9. The spine or backbone is **umqolo** or **umnyele** 10, 11. The ribs are generally called **ubambo** 12, with the lowest or "false" ribs known as **intlala** 12.
- **Limbs and Extremities:** The foreleg is the **umkono** 13, while the hindleg is the **umlenze** 10. The hoof is known as **inqina** or **ipupu** 14, 15. The tail is the **umsila** 16, which ends in the **itshoba** (tail brush) 17.

Internal Anatomy: The Innards (*Izibilini*)

The internal organs, collectively called **izibilini** 6, are described with high specificity in the context of butchering.

- **Vital Organs:** The heart is the **intliziyo** 4, protected by the **isipapu** (pericardium) 18. The lungs and liver are sometimes referred to collectively as **ipapu** 18, though the liver specifically is **isibindi** 19. The milt or spleen is **ubende** 20. The gall or bile is **inyongo** 21, and the bladder is **isinyi** 22.
- **The Digestive System:** Ruminants like cattle and sheep have complex stomachs. The whole stomach is the **isisu** 23. The paunch or tripe is **ulusu** 24. The third stomach (manyplies) is the **isindlwane** 25, and the lowest stomach is the **injeke** 26.
- **Intestines and Related Parts:** Intestines are **amatumbu** 27. The large intestine is **uqumbu** 28 or **ubolobolo** 29. The rectum is known as **undonci** 30. Terms for the colon include **iduntso** 31 and **umnyonkolo** 32.
- **Structural Materials:** The diaphragm is known as the **isiqanga** 33. Marrow inside the bones is **umongo** 34, while the specialized oil in bone substance is **umxo** 35. The partially digested food in the stomach is **umswane** 36.

Tradition and Anatomy of the Cut

Specific parts of the anatomy are tied to social rank and ritual during slaughter.

- **Sacred Fat:** The **intlukuhla** (fat on the liver) is the first part offered in a sacrifice to appease ancestors 37.
- **Best Cuts:** The **intsonyama** is the choice meat found behind the shoulder, reserved for chiefs or wedding couples 38. The **incum** (brisket) is also a prized portion 39.

- **Hierarchy of the Hindquarter:** The **inxaxeba** (right hindquarter) is a mark of honor sent by a senior chief to a junior chief 40. The left hindquarter is referred to as the **idikazi** 10.

Anatomy of Small Stock and Fowl

- **Birds/Fowl:** The crop of a fowl is the **indlelo** 41, and the gizzard is the **igila** 42.
- **Small Game:** For animals like the **intenetya** (rock hare), the tender flesh near the kidneys is called the **umhlubulo** 43.